Bites and Envenomations

TE-01 | Toxicology & Environmental

Quick flow

01 Scene Safe? [EMT / AEMT / Paramedic]

Stage or request resources until animal, insect, or environmental hazard is controlled.

02 ABCs / Anaphylaxis / Shock [EMT / AEMT / Paramedic]

Treat immediate threats and route to age-appropriate allergy or shock protocol.

03 Wound + Immobilize [EMT / AEMT / Paramedic]

Clean/cover the wound when it will not delay care, remove constricting items, and immobilize the extremity in a neutral position of comfort.

04 Snake Bite? [EMT / AEMT / Paramedic]

Mark swelling/redness with time; keep the patient calm, keep the limb at heart level, call Poison Help, and transport promptly. Do not apply ice, tourniquet, suction, or incision.

05 Spider / Sting? [EMT / AEMT / Paramedic]

For a visible stinger, scrape it away; wash the area and use a cold pack for 10-20 minutes. Treat anaphylaxis immediately when present.

06 Consult + Transport [EMT / AEMT / Paramedic]

For suspected envenomation, unknown toxic bite/sting, or concerning symptoms, call Poison Help (1-800-222-1222). For animal bites/scratches, follow the local public-health/animal-control reporting process and arrange evaluation for rabies risk assessment.

Overview

- Prioritize scene safety, wound care, immobilization, removal of constricting items, and treatment of anaphylaxis or shock.
- Do not endanger responders to capture or identify an animal; use a description or photograph when safely available.

Provider-Level Actions

Protect rescuers, stop exposure when safe, support ABCs, and involve Poison Control or Medical Control early.

EMT

- Provide wound care when it will not delay care, remove rings/bands, immobilize the extremity in a neutral position of comfort, mark progression, and treat anaphylaxis with epinephrine when indicated.
- For a visible insect stinger, scrape it away; wash the area and use a cold pack for 10-20 minutes.
- For suspected envenomation, unknown toxic bite/sting, or concerning symptoms, contact Poison Help (1-800-222-1222). For possible rabies exposure, follow the local public-health/animal-control reporting process.

AEMT

- Perform all EMT care plus IV/IO access, fluids, and authorized pain/anaphylaxis treatment.

Paramedic

- Perform all prior care plus cardiac monitoring for systemic illness and treat severe venom-associated muscle spasm or seizure under the applicable medication and seizure protocol.

Indications

- Animal/human bite, insect sting, or suspected snake/spider envenomation.

Warnings / precautions

- Do not capture or transport a snake for identification.
- Do not apply ice to a snake bite.
- Do not delay transport for snake-bite interventions or identification.

Related pathways / contacts

Medication Reference - Open for approved midazolam indications, dosing, and monitoring.

Source and references

Claiborne County EMS approved protocol manual. | Poison Help national line: 1-800-222-1222. | Current Tennessee EMS scope of practice and Claiborne County standing orders control for all provider permissions.

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